

SUMMARY

Cognitive psychologist and behavioral scientist specializing in human–robot interaction, with 10+ years of experience designing controlled behavioral studies and analyzing trial-level data. Focused on how people adapt communication to robotic interaction partners, combining experimental methods with mixed-effects and ordinal modeling in R. Experienced in translating complex behavioral data into clear, actionable insights for research, interaction, and system design across varied audiences.

CORE CAPABILITIES

Research design: Experimental design; user and interaction studies; task/survey design; behavioral coding; human–AI interaction.
Data & statistics: Trial-level analysis; mixed-effects and ordinal (cumulative link) models; regression; reproducible workflows in R; data management.
Tools: Analysis and DataViz (R; SPSS; JASP); Data Collection (Qualtrics; OpenSesame; HTML/CSS); Behavioral Coding (ELAN); Choregraphe (NAO robot software).
Languages: Turkish (native); English (fluent).

EXPERIENCE

- Doctoral Researcher @ Koç University, Istanbul

Sep 2020 – Aug 2026

 - Led end-to-end behavioral research on how speakers adapt communication to human versus robotic listeners, from study design through analyses, publications, and presentations.
 - Designed and ran controlled interactive experiments with 160 participants and 6,080 trials, covering protocols, robot interaction programming, participant data management, and reproducible R pipelines.
 - Modeled trial-level data with mixed-effects ordinal models to detect real-time adaptation in speakers' speech content.
 - Tested user responses to system feedback and interaction failures.
- Editorial Assistant @ European Open Science, Remote

Jul 2023 – May 2025

 - Managed the editorial workflow for 15 academic journals, covering submission checks, revision tracking, copyediting, production, and publication, as primary contact for authors.
 - Maintained consistent documentation and process standards across concurrent journal pipelines.
- Project Coordinator @ MEF University, Istanbul

Jul 2020 – Jan 2022

 - Coordinated operations for a grant-funded longitudinal study (TÜBİTAK 1003), managing research staff, data-collection workflows, and partner-institution communication, and standardizing documentation across collaborating institutions.
- Data Intern @ Education Reform Initiative, Istanbul

Jul 2019 – Sep 2019

 - Developed a project proposal focused on improving data literacy among ERG's audience, with an emphasis on making education data more accessible and usable.
 - Contributed to the preparation of the Education Monitoring Indicators 2020 Report, supporting data compilation, interpretation, and report development.
- Research Assistant @ Tilburg University, Netherlands

Feb 2017 – Feb 2018

 - Designed and ran a personalized language-learning study for Turkish–Dutch bilingual children using a NAO social robot with tablet-based interaction, as part of the EU Horizon 2020 [L2tor](#) project.
 - Worked with Tilburg and Utrecht teams to localize the system and integrate child-development and interaction requirements into the learning task.

EDUCATION

- Doctor of Philosophy, Psychology (Cognitive Track), Koç University, Istanbul

Sep 2020 – Aug 2026
- Associate Degree, Web Design and Coding, Anadolu University

Sep 2019 – Jun 2021
- Research Master, Language and Communication, Radboud University, Nijmegen

Sep 2016 – Aug 2018
- Bachelor of Arts, Psychology, with Certificate in Linguistics, Boğaziçi University, Istanbul

Sep 2011 – Jun 2016

AWARDS & TRAINING

- IEEE Robotics & Automation Society Travel Support Award

2026
- Data Analysis School – Artificial Intelligence Track, YÖK & Marmara University

2026
- TÜBİTAK 2211-A National PhD Scholarship

2020 – 2024
- Holland Scholarship, Dutch Ministry of Education, Culture and Science

2016 – 2018
- Higher Education Scholarship, Turkish Ministry of Youth and Sports — top 100 nationally, university entrance exam

2011 – 2016